US History · Unit 2 · Level 2 (modified)

The Heartland: Moving West



TODAY'S PLAN

- ➡️ Manifest Destiny
- 🚂 The transcontinental railroad
- 🏡 Life on the Plains
- 🦬 Native nations and the buffalo

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



🖼️ Political cartoons show an **opinion**.

🔍 **BASIC**: Background, Argument, Symbols, Indicators, Caricature.

🤔 Quick think: what does a symbol do?

Words to Know

Words to Know



Manifest Destiny

The belief that the United States should spread west across North America.



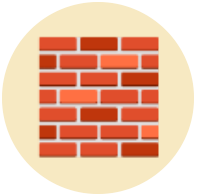
Railroad

The transcontinental railroad (1869) joined the East and the West.



Homestead Act

A law (1862) that gave 160 acres of land to people who lived on it and farmed it for 5 years.



Sod house

A house built from blocks of grassy soil, because the plains had few trees.

Words to Know

More Words to Know



🦬 **Buffalo**: The American bison. Plains nations used it for food, clothes and homes. Hunters killed millions.

⛺ **Reservation**: Land the US government set aside for Native nations, often far from their homelands.

🧳 **Exodusters**: African Americans who left the South for Kansas after the Civil War to find freedom and land.

🤠 **Cowboy**: A worker who drove cattle on the open range. About 1 in 4 were African American, and many were Mexican vaqueros.

Learn

American Progress (1872)

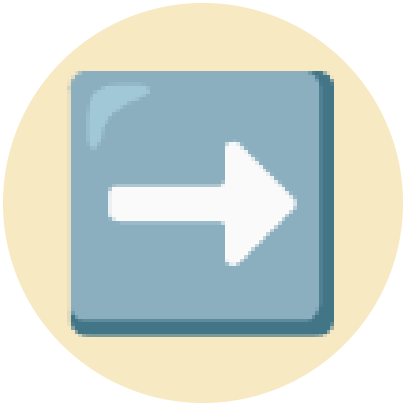
John Gast painted **“American Progress”** in 1872.

A giant woman floats **west**, stringing telegraph wire. Light follows her; the left side is dark.

Native people and buffalo flee ahead of her. The painting shows the artist's view, not the Native view.



🃏 Check 1 of 4



What idea does the painting show?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Americans should stay in the East

2️⃣ Manifest Destiny: the US should spread west

3️⃣ Native nations welcomed settlers



Manifest Destiny: the US should spread west

The painting celebrates moving west.

Learn

The Transcontinental Railroad

The railroad was finished at Promontory Point, Utah in **1869**.

Thousands of **Chinese** workers built the western part. The work was dangerous and paid less.

Trains brought settlers, cattle and goods west.



🃏 Check 2 of 4



How did the railroad change the West?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ It stopped people from moving

2️⃣ It only carried mail

3️⃣ It brought many settlers quickly

✅ Answer · Card 2 of 4



It brought many settlers quickly

Fast travel brought settlers and trade.

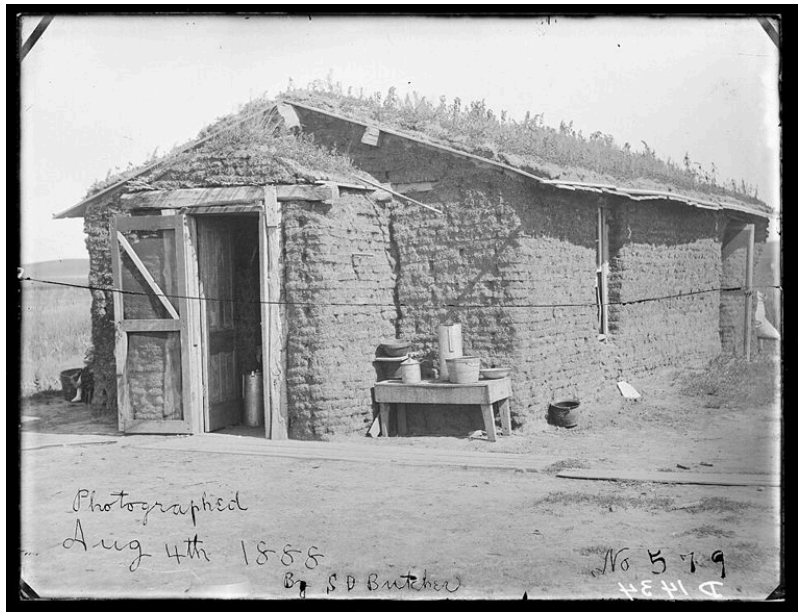
Learn

Life on the Plains

The **Homestead Act** (1862) gave 160 acres to families who farmed it 5 years.

Few trees grew, so families built **sod houses** and burned dried **buffalo chips** for fuel.

Hard parts: being alone, wild weather and insects.



Learn

Exodusters



After the Civil War, thousands of African Americans moved from the South to **Kansas**.

They were called **Exodusters**, from the Bible's Exodus.

They wanted land and freedom away from Southern violence.

Learn

Cowboys of the Open Range

About **55,000** cowboys worked the Plains (1865–1885).

About 1 in 4 was **African American**; many were **Mexican** vaqueros.

Spanish gave us words like rodeo, lasso and corral. This is cowboy Nat Love.



Learn

The Buffalo

Plains nations used the buffalo for food, clothing and shelter.

Hunters and railroad passengers killed **millions** of buffalo.

By the late 1880s fewer than 1,000 were left.



🃏 Check 3 of 4



Why was killing the buffalo so harmful to Plains nations?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ They depended on it for food, clothes and homes

2️⃣ They did not use buffalo

3️⃣ Buffalo were only for sport



They depended on it for food, clothes and homes

The buffalo was their way of life.

Learn

Conflict on the Plains



1864 Sand Creek
militia attacked a peaceful Cheyenne and Arapaho camp



1868 Fort Laramie
treaty for Lakota land



1876 Little Bighorn
Lakota and Cheyenne defeat Custer



1890 Wounded Knee
US Army kills about 300 Lakota

Learn

The Dawes Act (1887)



The **Dawes Act** broke up reservation land into 160-acre plots.

Land that was “left over” was sold to settlers.

Native nations lost about two-thirds of their land.

🃏 Check 4 of 4



What did the Dawes Act do?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Gave free land to Exodusters

2️⃣ Built the railroad

3️⃣ Broke up tribal land into small plots

✅ Answer · Card 4 of 4



Broke up tribal land into small plots

It split up reservations, and Native nations lost land.

🎬 Video

America: The Story of Us, “Heartland”

Scan to watch

👀 Watch for: Chinese workers, buffalo, cowboys, settlers

💬 Captions on

https://www.dailymotion.com/video/xwip7r

Wrap-Up

Recap



Manifest Destiny

spread west



Railroad

1869, Chinese workers



Homestead Act

160 acres



Dawes Act

Native land lost

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



Name 2 groups who changed the West and how.

Why did settlers build sod houses?

Give 1 positive and 1 negative effect of westward expansion.